

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS – STRATEGIC PLANNING AND BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

Fit with Strategic Planning / Business Development Role

- Please walk me through your resume/tell me about yourself.
- Why do you want a position in strategic planning/business development?
- Why does this industry interest you? A
- What are your thoughts on the evolution of this industry vertical over next few years (in terms of products, technologies, markets)?
- What do you consider to be the competitive landscape of our industry, specifically highlighting our company's strengths and weaknesses relative to our peers?
- Where do you see this industry going / How do you think the [TOYS/GAMES] industry is different from the rest of the CPG industry?
- What do you perceive are the negatives about this company?
- What has been your most significant leadership experience?
- Describe a team experience that did not work well. Why didn't it work well? How did you handle it?
- Describe a team experience which worked well. Why did it work well?
- Describe a situation when you had to work with ambiguity. How did you deal with the situation and what was the result?
- Tell me about a situation in work where you experienced conflict and how you resolved it
- Describe an experience when you had to convince someone/a peer/ a manager.
- What questions do you have about our company? / Do you have any additional questions about our company?
- What are your short-term and long-term goals?
- How do you believe your experiences qualify you for strategic planning/business development?
- Why did you decide to leave your previous career?
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Additional Questions for Business Development Subset

- Describe any prior financial modeling experience you have. How would you rate your ability to develop financial models?
- How would you go about proposing and evaluating a deal?
- How would you go about negotiating a deal?
- What do you feel are the three most important things to make a deal occur?

For Strategic Planning Applicants

Be prepared for consulting style cases in every interview. It is critical that you have researched the company's industry and related opportunities/challenges as cases will likely center on these areas. However, you may also receive unrelated industry case scenarios. A typical interview for Strategic Planning/Business Development consists of one-half "fit" interview and one-half "case interview". In many cases, the fit interview may also account for a larger share of overall interview time

Fit with the Firm

- What other companies are you interviewing with?
- How will you decide between competing offers?
- What do you think will be the toughest part of this job?

Analytical skills

- Tell me about a time when you had to convince someone of something using data.
- What problems did you resolve in your most recent job?
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Strategic thinking skills

- How do you evaluate whether a potential partnership or an acquisition would be worthwhile?

Leadership skills

- Describe your leadership style
- How do you define leadership?
- What is the one thing I should take back to my fellow interviewers to remember you by?
- Tell me three instances of when you were most proud about yourself.
- What was the most challenging or riskiest decision you have made?
- How do you set targets? How do you quantify and measure the outcomes?
- Which leader is your role model and why? How has he/she influenced you?

Team skills

- Tell me the advantages & disadvantages of teamwork.
- Tell me about your last experience working in a team and what role you played
- Tell me about a time when your opinion was challenged. How did you handle it?
- Give me an example of when you were a mentor to someone else.
- Describe a time where you resolved a disagreement.
- Provide an example of how you have successfully used a network within an organization.
- How would other members of your current team describe you?

Additional Questions About Your Fit with the Firm / Role

- Provide an example of your creative skills.
- Describe your presentations skills and experience.
- What is something you are passionate about?
- On your last performance evaluation, what was something you needed to work on?
- What do you do for fun?
- What motivates you?